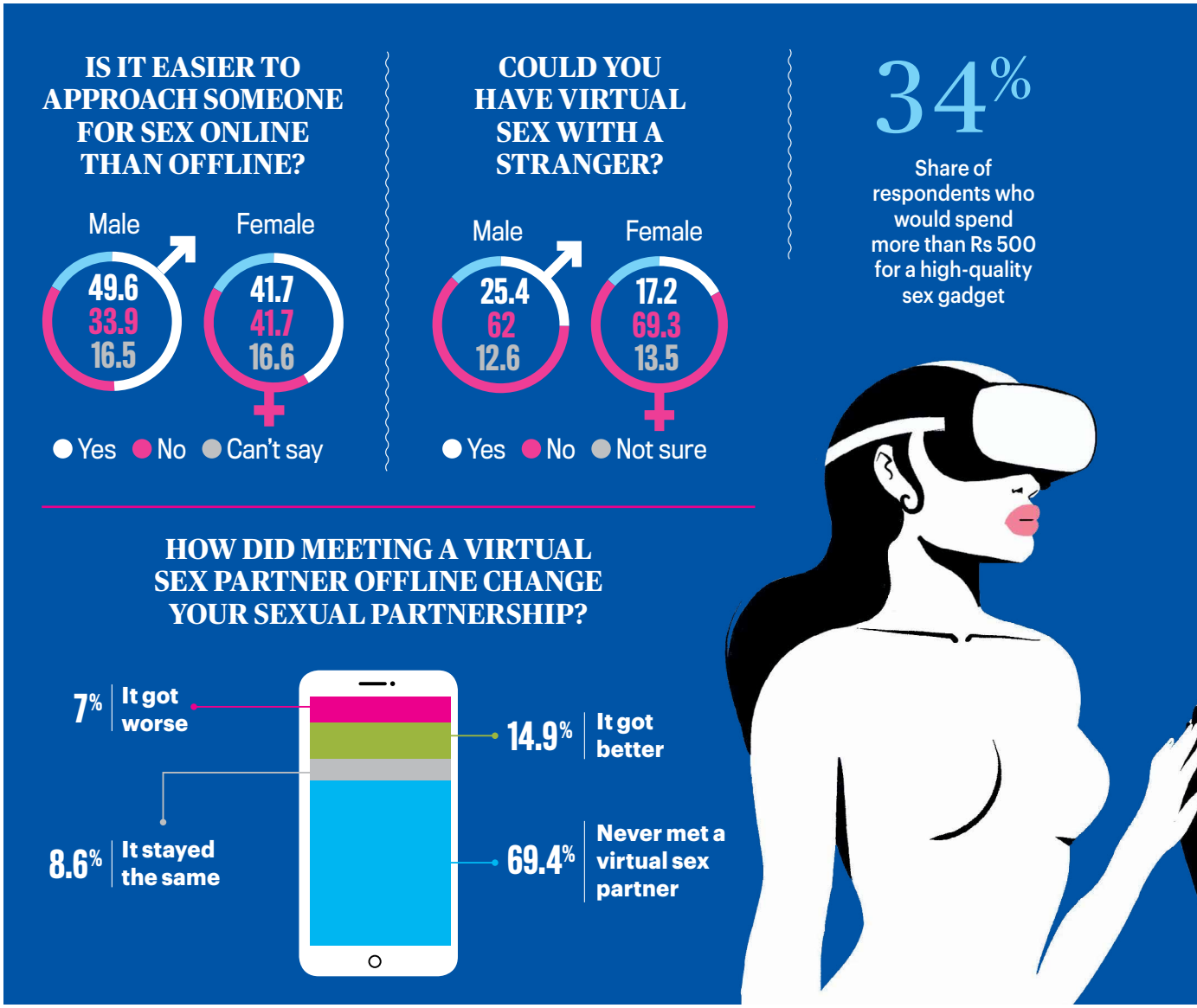



That more people are now in tune with their sexual needs is also evident from the range of sex gadgets available today. Around 36 per cent of the INDIA TODAY survey respondents said that sex gadgets could replace physical intimacy with a real person. Today, top companies like IMBesharam, Lovetreats and Kinkpin have merchandise lists that have gone beyond the once-popular rings, lubricants and outfits. It's the age of far more advanced gadgets now: there is Motorbunny, available in India for Rs 4 lakh, which can mimic intercourse by inducing similar bodily movements in users; another gadget, Fleshlight, can cost between Rs 8,000 and Rs 16,000, depending on how real one wants the artificial vagina to feel. Artificial Intelligence has made sex toys smarter than ever before—Hot Octopuss is an auto oral sex machine for men that can work on a flaccid penis, and Lovense vibrators now offer wireless dildos with pre-enabled mechanisms that will adjust their movements based on the shape of a vagina. Then there are AI-powered sex 'robots' that can tell jokes, converse and remember names. At

## BEYOND ADVANCES IN SEXTECH, EMOTIONAL INTIMACY REMAINS A CRUCIAL NEED

$20,000, the Harmony robot can be bought overseas easily. Nearly 40 per cent of the respondents said they might even consider using such a robot. That's not all—most porn websites today allow syncing with popular VR systems such as Google Cardboard and Oculus Rift. A study published in the *Journal of Sex Research* found that when men watched VR porn, they felt more desired and connected. That's not surprising, given how VR porn allows you to play a character.